

eyecatchers



DREAM TICKET

What's Bollywood without some oomph and sex appeal? So when a model makes a foray into the industry, we welcome her with a standing ovation. **Laila Khan**, 22, a half-Iranian and half-Kashmiri model, will ride the Bollywood wave for a ticket to stardom. The former Miss Vancouver has already bagged one Tamil and two Hindi films, *Molly* and *Meri Teri Shaadi*. Khan wants to be a "versatile actress" and is keen on item songs. Look forward to some sizzling numbers.

A Different League

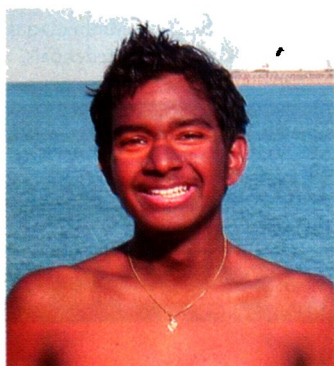


Their families may be slogging it out in the dusty political battlefields but the GenNext of the country's politicians are giving it a miss in favour of Bollywood. While Congressman Arjun Singh's grandson Arunodaay Singh will be seen in a film directed by Vinay Shukla, Kartikadevi Rane, niece of Goa's former chief minister Pratapsinh Rane, is set to make her Hindi screen debut with Handmade Films' *Hulla*. The right way to go?



GROWTH CURVES

After her girl-next-door role in *Bachna Ae Haseeno*, **Minissha Lamba** is setting the screens ablaze in her next film, *Kidnap*. Donning a bikini, the actor will play a 17-year-old girl kidnapped by Imran Khan, who wants to take revenge on her father. "This movie is a perfect opportunity to flaunt my curves," says the actor, who went through rigorous training and a stiff diet regime for eight months to get fighting fit.



Riding on a High Tide

Braving the chilly waters and sharks in the Straits of Gibraltar, Mumbai teen Prateek Srivastava has set a record by becoming the fastest swimmer in Asia to cross the straits. The 16-year-old swam the 23-km stretch from Tarifa to the Morocco coast in three hours and 27 minutes, breaking the earlier record by seven minutes. For the young champ, who took to the waters as a schoolboy, the next milestone is the English Channel. A shark himself, eh?



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